from APEC."[12] The Asia-Pacific is sometimes used to describe the countries included in the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC) group.[13] It does not include all the member states of the ASEAN, and it excludes the countries of Central and South Asia. At the other end of the scale, Asia-Pacific, as used by the United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (ESCAP) in its annual "Asia-Pacific Trade and Investment Report,"[14] divides countries into five subregions: East and Northeast Asia,[15] Southeast Asia,[16] South and Southwest Asia,[17] North and Central Asia,[18] and the Pacific.[19] It spans a region from Armenia and Turkey in the West to New Zealand and the Pacific Island states in the East and from Russia in the North to Sri Lanka in the South, but it does not include countries in North or South America, in contrast to the APEC. It follows from these two examples, the APEC and the UN ESCAP, that it could be confusing and misleading when the term "Asia-Pacific" is used to describe two such vastly different geographic areas, underlining that the new label "Indo-Pacific" has merit in describing an area that covers both the Indian Ocean Region and the Asia-Pacific region.

Furthermore, the Indo-Pacific can be understood as a region that encompasses the area between the Horn of Africa and South Africa, including the entire expanse of the East African seaboard, and Australia, the Pacific Islands, and the West Coasts of North and South America. On the landmass, it covers the entire Asian part of extended Eurasia, stretching from Central Asia (especially the "istans") and Eurasia, across Siberia, covering a large part of the Russian Federation, Mongolia, China, and the continental part of Southeast Asia (Figure 9.1).